

Customer Discovery Synthesis and Business Model Canvas

Week 4 | BUS 395: Venture Creation with AI

Student: Jane Dias

Date: June 15, 2026

Venture: AI styling on-demand platform

Interviews: 5 completed

1. INTERVIEW INSIGHTS REPORT

Summary

I conducted 5 interviews with women with various ages, socioeconomic status, and lifestyles. All fit within my target demographic. Interviews ranged from 8-13 minutes, and were recorded using voice memos and Granola for transcription.

a. Pattern Map

Confirmed Patterns (3+ interviewees independently)

Pattern 1: The Core Question is Always "Does This Actually Look Good on Me?" and No One Has a Reliable Answer

Every interviewee struggled with the same thing. Not "does it fit?" but "does it look right on my specific body?"

Pattern 2: External Validation is the Universal Workaround

All 5 women cope the same way: ask someone they trust. Allison texts photos to friends/family. Aly asks whoever she's shopping with. Danai texts husband, sisters, kids, and won't buy if they hesitate even slightly. Mya FaceTimes her mom or twin sister. Meg wishes she had "someone skilled" in body-type styling.

But the system has a reliability problem Mya names explicitly: "sometimes when you ask a friend, they're just trying to be nice." Sales associates are biased. Friends are unreliable. Family varies. There's a gap between needing honest feedback and actually getting it.

Pattern 3: Online Shopping is Where the Problem Compounds

Every single interviewee has unworn items from online purchases. The cause is almost never the wrong size, it's that things fit but don't look right on their proportions. Allison missed a return window. Aly got stuck with non-returnable sale items. Danai bought something that looked great under store lighting but was a "what was I thinking" moment at home. Mya bought it without trying. Meg got "curvy" jeans that were completely wrong for her body shape.

Returns are the workaround, not the fix.

Pattern 4: Proportions Are the Real Pain Point, Not Size

Multiple women described having a "hard to fit" body in ways that go beyond standard sizing. Danai has a small waist with bigger hips/thighs, pants and shorts fit "weird." Meg has narrow hips and a thicker waist, she bought "curvy" jeans and they failed completely; her daughter can't find anything that fits at American Eagle either. Aly's pale complexion means many colors wash her out, and she keeps picking the wrong ones even when she knows better. Allison's tall frame means fit issues across categories.

Pattern 5: Style Knowledge Takes Decades to Develop, Younger Women Are Still in the Mistake Phase

Allison (40s) is the most confident (90% of mornings) because she's built a "formula" over decades. She explicitly says it took years, she made many mistakes, and she wishes she'd had a personal stylist. Danai follows influencers with her body type as a shortcut. Aly and Mya (both 20s) report feeling confident only 40–50% of the time. Meg (30s, post-pregnancy) says she "very rarely" feels confident, partly because her body has changed.

The pattern: confidence is an outcome of accumulated trial-and-error, not something women are taught.

Pattern 6: Low Confidence Has Real Behavioral Stakes

Mya: "I don't want to be so seen in public" when the outfit isn't working. Allison will not leave the house if she doesn't feel confident; changes completely. Aly compensates with hair and makeup when the outfit falls short. Danai has a separate "work outfit" she doesn't feel comfortable wearing anywhere else.

Confident outfit = willing to be photographed, go out, be seen. Unconfident outfit = avoidance behavior.

Pattern 7: The Photo/Video Workaround Signals Comfort with Visual-Based Feedback

Multiple women already take photos or spin-videos of themselves in clothes to self-assess (Mya, Danai, Allison). They're already doing a version of "send a picture, get feedback." This is a

behavior already normalized , suggesting a photo-based, on-demand feedback tool would feel natural, not foreign.

Contradictions

Confidence doesn't change the type of problems, just the frequency

Each woman, despite the level of confidence they had, struggled with issues with their wardrobe. However, the more confident someone is, the less issues they face. Allison and Danai still face problems, even though they have discovered workarounds for themselves.

In-store try-on

All five women agreed that in-store try-on produces better outcomes than online shopping. Danai's experience "I don't know if maybe the store mirror and the lights just made it look amazing. And then when I got home and actually saw it in real light in my bathroom, I was like, what the hell was I thinking?" Shows that the supposedly superior solution has its own failure mode.

Surprises

Nobody said "I don't know my size"

The older women are more explicit. Danai ("smaller waist, bigger hips and thighs") and Meg ("narrow hips and a thicker waist") gave precise descriptions of their bodies. Allison named being tall. Aly and Mya in their 20s were more vague. Aly talked about coloring and silhouettes in general terms, and Mya didn't describe a body type challenge at all.

b. Key Quotes

Quote	Why it matters
"It really took years for me to develop my ability to pick out clothes and know if I was going to wear them... I didn't have a personal stylist, I didn't have somebody like, helping me figure out outfits, which would have been great. But it was really a lot of trial and error, and I've made a lot of mistakes." (Allison)	Describes what people are missing- 20 years of shopping experience, and for those who cannot afford, personal styling advice.
"I kind of do need people to tell me what it looks like, because I can't see. I can't get a 360 of myself sometimes." (Mya)	Reveals shopping and getting dressed alone is harder than shopping with other people- she revealed she can't make that call alone.
"Sometimes when you do ask a friend, they're just trying to be nice, and they won't give you, I feel, like, real input on the outfit... sometimes I do feel like people are just trying to be nice." (Mya)	The gap isn't access to opinions, it's access to opinions without a social incentive to be polite.
"Having somebody who is trusted give me some feedback on the outfit... tell me, like, yeah, that is not a good look for you... If somebody who I trusted really would give me that kind of feedback, that would be helpful." (Allison)	This was her direct answer to "what would have helped?". Revealing that trust is a very important part of receiving feedback for style choices.
"I very rarely feel confident in what I'm wearing, but it's mostly a body image issue." (Meg)	Reveals that there are problems deeper than clothing, that styling tools and guidance cannot reach or help.
"Until you actually start wearing the item out of it, you almost don't know if you like it. You think you do, but something about it can bug you when you actually put it on and wear it out." (Meg)	You cannot promise that someone will like something beyond the mirror. Putting limitations on the solution.
"I think I just go off my own gut feeling... That's more about how I feel about stuff, more than the fit. Because I pretty much have figured out the fit, right?"	The problem extends from the mirror into identity. When fit and identity are solved, her question is whether or not she is projecting the right version of herself, which the product can't answer.

"I understand the sales associate is just trying to make a sale... it's more reassuring when you ask a friend or family member and they give you the thumbs up." (Allison)	Challenges the trustworthiness of programs being commercially affiliated. If an AI seems to be pushing sales or attached to a brand, it could reduce trustworthiness.
--	---

c. Assumption Scorecard

Assumption 1: Women regardless of age (20–60) experience this issue

Evidence For: All 5 interviewees confirmed the problem exists across age groups. Aly (20s) feels confident in outfits 50% of the time. Mya (20s) 40%. Meg (30s) very rarely, her body changed through pregnancy. Danai (50s) returned items this summer because they didn't fit her body well. Allison (40s) still has unworn items from online purchases.

Evidence Against: Intensity varies significantly depending on life stage. Allison is 90% confident and has largely self-solved through decades of trial and error. Danai: "I pretty much have figured out the fit, right?" signaling low acute pain. Women who have reached a stable period with a working formula don't feel the problem urgently, even if they're within the 20–60 range.

Verdict: Partially Confirmed

What Changes: Segment by life moment instead. The target customer is a woman who is currently in a disruption, either she has never developed her formula yet, or a life transition has broken the one she had.

Assumption 2: Women with limited budgets have less room for trial and error

Evidence For: Aly bought Old Navy athletic wear on sale, couldn't return it, never wore items that didn't fit. Mya bought a Target tube top without trying it on, couldn't return it.

Evidence Against: Allison (larger budget) also has items with tags sitting in her closet because she missed return windows on online purchases. Danai (very budget-conscious) built a more disciplined return system precisely because of her budget: "I'd rather get my money back... that's why online shopping is so much easier, because I can just return it at UPS."

Verdict: Partially Confirmed

What Changes: Stop framing the problem as worse for budget-constrained women specifically. The mechanism is non-returnable sale purchases, which traps any income level.

Assumption 3: Women don't know their body type or measurements

Evidence For: Meg bought "curvy" jeans without understanding what the cut meant in proportional terms. Aly struggles to identify which silhouettes work for her body.

Evidence Against: Almost every interviewee described their body with precision and without prompting. Danai: "I have a smaller waist, but bigger hips and thighs." Meg in the same

interview: "I got more narrow hips and a thicker waist." Allison built her formula around knowing she's tall. Mya didn't express confusion about her body type at all.

Verdict: Disproven

What Changes: Rather than focusing on body-type discovery, the gap is how to apply it to actual clothing decisions.

Assumption 4: A personal stylist or large budget solves the problem

Evidence For: Allison (larger budget) is the most confident at 90%. She explicitly said she wished she'd had a personal stylist earlier.

Evidence Against: Meg worked in fashion and very rarely feels confident, showing expertise doesn't transfer to dressing your own body. Allison's confidence came from decades of trial and error, not a stylist or budget. She still has unworn online purchases despite her larger budget.

Verdict: Inconclusive

What Changes: Stop using "personal stylist for women who can't afford one" as the positioning frame because it assumes stylists solve the problem, which isn't validated. Frame instead around the specific gap neither budget nor expertise closes: honest, proportions-aware feedback at the moment of decision.

Assumption 5: Seeking a second opinion signals self-doubt

Evidence For: Mya and Aly (the least confident interviewees) rely most heavily on external validation before purchasing.

Evidence Against: Allison who is 90% confident still sends photos to friends and family when uncertain. Mya described shopping as "social" and a "big part" of the experience. Danai uses external feedback as a decision rule: "if they are hesitant in any way, I just won't get it" , which is a system, not insecurity. The behavior is identical across all confidence levels.

Verdict: Disproven

What Changes: Reframe the product positioning entirely. Don't target women who doubt themselves , that frames the product as a crutch and shrinks the market. Position around making a behavior that all women already do, seeking external input, more honest and reliable.

2. VENTURE DIRECTION DECISION

Refined Problem Statement: Women understand their proportions but not how to apply that knowledge to clothing decisions, and the feedback they can access, either from friends too polite to be honest and sales associates too biased to be trusted doesn't bridge that gap.

(Grounded in: Danai and Meg both describing their bodies precisely yet returning items that didn't work. Mya: "sometimes they're just trying to be nice." Allison: "the sales associate is just trying to make a sale." Aly knowing certain colors wash her out yet still picking them.)

Refined Target Customer:

Women ages 22-35 who are building a formula for the first time (post-college, first real job, first major style context shift) OR a life transition just broke the one she had (pregnancy, weight change, new life stage).

Chosen Direction

Remix 1: Advice at the Mirror

A photo-based tool that delivers honest, personalized styling feedback at the moment of decision, with minimal onboarding friction and a freemium model that lets users experience value before being asked to pay. Upon first use, users may be asked to upload themselves wearing various basic-pieces in their wardrobe along with providing measurements. However, the product's job is not education about body type. It is helping women apply what they already know to specific clothing decisions in real time.

What Changed

Week 1 framed the root cause as women not knowing their body type, and Week 2's systems analysis reinforced it, with body shape education being listed as a core leverage point. The interviews disproved both. Every interviewee could describe her proportions precisely without prompting; the gap was never self-knowledge, it was applying that knowledge to specific

decisions in real time. What did hold up was the system map's informal advice loop, friends provide temporary relief but don't resolve the problem. Mya's "sometimes they're just trying to be nice" and Allison's note about biased sales associates named the honesty gap the map left implicit. The Week 3 competitive analysis framing, which was a decision system at the time of need prevailed as the strongest direction.

Biggest Remaining Risk

There is limited information about whether or not the target customer will actually pay for this product. My plan is to ask Aly and Mya and inquire what money they are willing to spend on a product that functions like this. I will also conduct additional research.

3. BUSINESS MODEL CANVAS

BUS 395: Venture Creation with AI ■ Week 4		BUSINESS MODEL CANVAS		Jane Dias ■ June 2026	
KEY PARTNERSHIPS Weak Evidence ■ • AI/LLM provider (hard dependency — core infrastructure) • Fashion/styling expertise to calibrate advice quality • Platform APIs: iMessage, WhatsApp, Instagram • Body-type influencers for distribution • No retail/brand partnerships — conflicts with honest positioning Not explored in interviews. Structural inference only.		KEY ACTIVITIES Moderate Evidence • Generate honest, proportions-aware styling feedback per session • Build user profile progressively through use • Close the feedback loop: kept item vs. returned • Organic content creation for discovery (Instagram/TikTok) Feedback loop closure depends on a user behavior not yet validated.	VALUE PROPOSITIONS Strong Evidence • Honest, specific feedback at the exact moment of decision • Not polite like a friend — not biased like a sales associate • Applies her body knowledge to specific items (translation layer) • Gets smarter and more personal with every session • “Trusted feedback — tell me, yeah, that’s not a good look” — Allison • “Sometimes just trying to be nice” — Mya (names the exact gap) Grounded in 5/5 interviews. Strongest block on the canvas.	CUSTOMER RELATIONSHIPS Moderate Evidence • 2–3 onboarding questions; value delivered on session 1 • Profile deepens progressively through use (not front-loaded) • Freemium: 8 free sessions → \$6/month • Switching cost grows as product learns her — retention built in 8-session freemium threshold is a hypothesis, not customer data.	CUSTOMER SEGMENTS Moderate Evidence • Women 22–35 whose wardrobe formula is missing or broken • Trigger: never built one, or life transition disrupted it • Sends photos, seeks opinions, still returns items • Mya (20s): 40% outfit confidence — target archetype • Aly (20s): 50% outfit confidence — target archetype Based on 5 interviews. Age range inferred, not statistically confirmed.
KEY RESOURCES Moderate Evidence • AI model calibrated for proportional fit — not generic styling • User profile data: builds with use (the product moat) • Founder domain knowledge: lived, personal connection to problem • Trust: earned through accuracy session by session Photo-based proportional fit assessment is technically unproven.		CHANNELS Weak Evidence ■ • Discovery: Instagram/TikTok organic content (problem she recognizes) • Discovery: body-type influencers who already have her trust • Access: app download or web sign-up (entry point) • Growth: referral — she already sends photos socially; product travels the same path No interviewee asked how they discover new tools. All channel logic is inference.			
COST STRUCTURE Weak Evidence ■ • AI inference cost per photo per session (scales with usage) • Product development: onboarding flow, profile algorithm, feedback loop • Customer acquisition: organic-first (content, referral) — low CAC at launch • Organic CAC estimate: \$10–20 (vs. \$100+ for paid acquisition) • Fashion app churn is typically high — unit economics not yet modeled No unit economics modeled. Must be run before anything is built.		REVENUE STREAMS Weak Evidence ■ • Free model at launch — lower barrier, faster trust-building • Post-decision ads in non-competing categories (skincare, lifestyle, travel) • Ads architecturally separated from advice engine — integrity preserved • Subscription (\$6/mo hypothetical) as optional premium tier once habit is formed Ad revenue negligible at early scale. Validate user base before monetizing.			

■ Strong Evidence

■ Moderate Evidence

■ Weak Evidence ■ (red blocks) — Priority to-dos for next interview round

4. CLAUDE CODE SESSION LOG

Uploaded separately